

Salary and Remote-Contracting Evidence for a Colombia-Based Unity / Real-Time 3D / Technical Visualization Candidate (2025–2026)

Approach

This section collects salary ranges, contractor rates, EOR/remote-hiring notes and administrative requirements relevant to a Colombia-based candidate who wants to work as a **Unity/Real-Time 3D Technical Visualization developer**. Roles examined include real-time/interactive 3D developer, Unity technical artist, Unity WebGL/Web 3D developer, technical visualization/digital twin/simulation developer, XR/AR/VR developer, tools/pipeline developer, Python/AI tools/LLM developer, full-stack developer and 3D artist. Data comes from salary aggregators, recruiter reports, job postings and official sources. Each entry notes the employment model (employee vs contractor), currency, seniority, confidence and relevance to a Colombia-based remote contractor.

Employee Salary Benchmarks by Role & Region (Annual USD unless noted)

The tables below summarise available annual salary ranges (with monthly equivalents). When no data was found the cell is marked **not found**. Salaries refer to gross amounts (before taxes and benefits). **jun** = junior, **mid** = mid-level, **sen** = senior.

Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
Real-Time / Interactive 3D Developer	US	mid/sen	~US\$138k/yr → \$11.5k/mo ¹	ZipRecruiter job-posting salary (2026)	Medium	Technical artist postings in the US pay ~\$127–152k/yr (includes 3D graphics & real-time roles) ¹ . Remote roles often require US work authorization; limited remote-worldwide options.

Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
	Canada	mid	CA\$105,983 (~US\$105k) in Toronto ²	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Medium	Qubit Labs lists mid-level Unity engineers in Toronto at US\$105,983/yr ² . Remote worldwide roles typically restricted to Canadian residents.
	UK	mid	~£77,512 (~US\$99k) ²	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Medium	Qubit Labs reports mid-level Unity salary in London at £77,512/yr (~US\$99k) ² .
	Germany	mid	€83,475 (~US\$90k) ²	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Medium	Mid-level Unity programmer salary in Berlin ≈ €83,475/yr ² .
	Australia	mid	AU\$85,668 (~US\$56k) ²	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Medium	Qubit Labs lists mid-level salary in Sydney at AU\$85,668 (~US\$56k) ² .
	Norway	mid	US\$73,419/yr ³	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Low	Norway salary in Qubit report; remote restrictions apply.
	Denmark	mid	US\$82,225/yr ⁴	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Low	Same source; remote restrictions apply.
	Spain	mid	US\$58,719/yr ⁵	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Low	Salaries lower; remote positions often require EU work authorization.
	Netherlands	mid	US\$76,073/yr ⁶	Qubit Labs salary report (2025)	Low	

Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
	LATAM (general)	mid	~US\$53–63k/yr ⁷	Howdy payroll data (2025)	Medium	Howdy payroll data lists average software-developer salaries across LATAM countries (employees) at ~\$53–63k/yr ⁷ .

	Colombia	mid	US\$55,894/yr ⁷	Howdy payroll data (2025)	Medium	Salaries for full-time software developers (EOR) in Colombia average US\$55,894/yr ⁷ . Remote world-wide roles often pay more when hired as contractor.
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Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
Unity Technical Artist / Technical Artist	US	mid/sen	\$127–152k/yr → \$10.5–12.7k/mo ¹	ZipRecruiter job-posting salary (2026)	Medium	Technical artist postings show averages ~US\$138k; ranges \$127k–\$152k ¹ .
	UK	mid	~£68.5k/yr (≈US\$86.5k) ⁸	ITJobsWatch data (2025)	Low	Limited data; median salary ~£68,500 with 25th percentile £66,750 ⁸ .

Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
	Canada	not found	not found	-	-	Lack of accessible data for technical artist salaries; rely on Unity developer salary ($\approx$ CA\$105k).
	Germany	not found	not found	-	-	Technical artist roles often integrated into game studios; salary similar to Unity developer ($\sim$ €83k).
	LATAM	not found	not found	-	-	Technical artist postings scarce; likely aligned with Unity developer salaries ($\sim$ US\$53–63k).
Unity WebGL / Web 3D Developer	US	mid	not found	-	-	Salary data rarely separate WebGL from Unity developer; treat equal to general Unity developer (US\$130k–130k).

Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
	Canada / Europe	mid	not found	–	–	Similar to Unity developer salaries above.
Technical Visualization / Digital Twin / Simulation Developer	US	mid	~US\$137,846/ yr → \$11.5k/ mo ⁹	ZipRecruiter (2026)	Medium	Simulation software engineer average \$137,846/yr; range \$104k–154k ⁹ .
			Digital twin engineer: \$80.5k– \$183k/yr ¹⁰ ¹¹	Job-posting salary (2026)	Medium	Digital twin engineer salary average \$139,368/yr; typical range \$80.5k– \$183k ¹⁰ ¹¹ .
	UK	mid	£35,493/yr (digital twin designer) ⁸ (Glassdoor)	Low		Glassdoor sample shows digital twin designer median £35,493/yr.
	Spain/ Portugal/ NL	not found	–	–		Data scarce; rely on general Unity developer salaries (US\$58k– 76k) ⁵ .

Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
XR / AR / VR Developer	US	junior/ mid/sen	Junior: \$84.5k– \$135k/yr (median \$109,750); mid: \$145k– \$223k (median \$184,261); senior: \$163.8k– \$248.8k (median \$206,342) ¹²	ARVRJobs salary insight (2026)	Medium	AR/VR developer salary ranges across seniorities ¹² .
	Canada/ Europe/ AUS	not found	–	–	Salary data limited; adopt general Unity developer ranges.	
Tools / Pipeline Developer	US	mid	not found	–	–	Tools/ pipeline roles usually fall under Unity technical artist or general software engineer; salary similar to Unity developer (~\$100– 130k).

Role family	Region	Seniority	Salary range (annual → monthly)	Source type & year	Confidence	Notes
Python Automation / AI Tools / LLM Application Developer	US	mid	\$44k (LATAM mid remote) – \$62k (senior) ¹³ for LATAM remote; US remote not found	HireTalent LATAM salary guide (2026)	Medium	HireTalent guide: remote Python developers in LATAM earn entry \$30k (≈\$2.5k/ mo), median \$44k (≈\$3.7k/ mo), senior \$62k (≈\$5.2k/ mo) ¹³ .
	LATAM	mid	\$30k–66k/yr (Colombia \$30k–66k) ¹³	HireTalent salary guide (2026)	High	Data covers remote Python developer salaries across LATAM; Colombian range \$30k– 66k/yr (≈\$3k–6k/ mo) ¹³ .
Full-stack Developer (fallback)	LATAM	mid	\$44k/yr median (Python) ¹³	HireTalent salary guide (2026)	Medium	Same as Python developer; not primary focus.
3D Artist / Blender Generalist (fallback)	US	mid	\$82,070/yr (range \$41k– 142k) ¹⁴	ZipRecruiter salary data (2026)	Medium	A 3D artist in the US earns \$82k/ yr on average; wide range; remote roles limited.

Key Takeaways

- **Unity/3D developer salaries vary widely by region and seniority.** Mid-level annual salaries range from ~US\$58k in Spain to ~US\$140k in Canada ¹⁵ . Senior roles in North America can exceed US\$150k.
- **Digital-twin and simulation engineers command high salaries in the US**, averaging ~\$138k–139k/yr ⁹ ¹⁰ . Data for Europe/Canada is scarce; expect lower pay (similar to Unity developer salaries).
- **AR/VR developer roles in the US offer high upside**, with mid-level salaries around \$184k/yr and seniors exceeding \$200k ¹² . Data for other regions is limited.
- **Python automation / AI tools roles in LATAM** pay significantly less (~\$44k/yr median) ¹³ . These roles are more accessible but may not meet high-income targets.
- **3D artist salaries are much lower** (~\$82k US average) ¹⁴ and rarely remote; this role should be avoided as a primary target.

Contractor Rate Evidence (Hourly USD)

Role family	Region	Seniority	Hourly rate	Source & year	Confidence	Notes
Unity Developer (general)	US	mid/sen	\$57/hr median, strong seniors \$72–\$89/hr ¹⁶	Lemon.io freelancer rates report (2026)	Medium	Report notes geography affects rate more than seniority; US seniors command \$72–\$89/hr ¹⁶ .
	Eastern Europe	mid/sen	\$40/hr mid; \$45–60/hr senior ¹⁶	Lemon.io report (2026)	Medium	European senior Unity developers bill \$45–\$60/hr ¹⁶ .
	LATAM (incl. Colombia)	mid	\$30–35/hr ¹⁶	Lemon.io report (2026)	Medium	Middle Unity developers in Colombia bill \$27–\$35/hr (approx. \$30–35/hr) ¹⁶ .
Unity Developer by country	Germany	mid	\$33–50/hr mid; \$45–60/hr senior ¹⁷	Lemon.io report (2026)	Medium	Mid-level Unity developers in Germany earn \$33–50/hr; seniors \$45–60/hr.

Role family	Region	Seniority	Hourly rate	Source & year	Confidence	Notes
Python Developer (LATAM)	Canada	mid	\$28–96/hr mid; \$38–95/hr senior ¹⁷	Lemon.io report (2026)	Medium	Wide range; high end likely onsite employees.
	Brazil	mid	\$30–40/hr mid; \$35–45/hr senior ¹⁷	Lemon.io report (2026)	Medium	Brazil rates align with LATAM averages.
	LATAM	entry/mid/sen	\$30k/yr (~\$14/hr) entry; \$44k/yr (~\$21/hr) mid; \$62k/yr (~\$29/hr) senior ¹³	HireTalent LATAM salary guide (2026)	Medium	Converted to hourly for comparison (annual/2080 hrs). Useful for Python automation route.

Notes on Contractor Rates

- **Colombia:** Middle Unity developers billing \$27–\$35/hr implies monthly earnings ~\$4.3k–6.0k (assuming 160 hrs/mo) ¹⁶.
- **Germany/Canada:** Mid-level Unity contractor rates often align with national salary costs (~\$33–50/hr in Germany, \$28–96/hr in Canada) ¹⁷.
- **US:** Contractor rates are highest, especially for strong seniors (\$72–\$89/hr) ¹⁶. These roles typically require US-only remote or relocation.

EOR / Remote Hiring Notes

Provider / Report	Key points	Evidence
Deel – 2025 Global Hiring Report	Highlights patterns in cross-border hiring: top-funded startups prefer talent over cost-saving and hire in wealthy countries (UK, Canada, Germany); roles requiring expertise like software developers and AI engineers dominate hires; emerging markets such as Latin America experience major salary growth ¹⁸ .	Deel global hiring report (2025 review): patterns emphasise that venture-backed startups choose talent over cost-saving and that LATAM roles see major salary growth ¹⁸ .
Mismo 2026 Compliance Guide	Distinguishes employees vs contractors; contractors have autonomy, use own equipment, invoice per project and pay their own social security; misclassification can lead to penalties and back payments ¹⁹ ²⁰ .	Mismo compliance guide for Colombia ¹⁹ ²⁰ .

Provider / Report	Key points	Evidence
Papaya Global – Hiring in Colombia	Independent contractors must have a RUT; electronic invoicing via DIAN; VAT applies at 19% with some exemptions; payments can be made via local bank transfer, PayPal, Wise or SWIFT; contractors should provide valid RUT to avoid higher withholding ²¹ ²² .	Papaya Global article ²¹ ²² .
Colombia Move Guide (2026)	Freelancers need RUT; electronic invoicing is mandatory when annual revenue > ≈COP 12 million; retención en la fuente (10%) applies for local clients; VAT (IVA) at 19% applies on most professional services, but individuals below 3,500 UVT (~COP 183 million) may be exempt ²³ ²⁴ ²⁵ .	2026 guide on freelancing in Colombia ²³ ²⁴ ²⁵ .
SIA Seguros 2026	Independent contractors must contribute to health (12.5%), pension (16%) and occupational risk insurance (ARL) based on 40% of monthly income (IBC); contributions are mandatory when earning ≥ 1 SMMLV (legal minimum wage) ²⁶ ²⁷ .	SIA Seguros article on social security for self-employed ²⁶ ²⁷ .

Colombia Administrative Requirements (Summary)

- **RUT (Registro Único Tributario):** Required for all freelancers and contractors to invoice; failure to register leads to higher withholding taxes ²¹ ²³ .
- **Electronic invoicing:** Independent contractors must issue electronic invoices through DIAN. Electronic invoicing becomes mandatory when annual income exceeds ≈COP 12 million (~US\$3k) ²³ .
- **Export of services / VAT:** Professional services exported abroad may be zero-rated if registered appropriately; most services in Colombia carry 19% VAT; individuals below 3,500 UVT (~COP 183 million) may not be liable for VAT ²⁴ ²⁵ .
- **Retención en la fuente (withholding tax):** Local clients must withhold ~10% income tax on payments to freelancers ²⁸ .
- **Social security contributions:** Contractors must contribute to health (12.5%), pension (16%) and ARL based on 40% of their monthly income; contributions are mandatory for incomes ≥ 1 SMMLV ²⁶ .
- **Payment methods:** Payments can be made via local bank transfer, PayPal, Wise or SWIFT; compliance with Banco de la República and AML regulations is necessary ²² .

Contractor / Remote Payment Platforms

Platform	Service	Notes
Deel / Remote / Oyster / Papaya / Plane	Employer-of-Record (EOR) and contractor management	Provide compliant payroll and invoicing for companies hiring contractors abroad. Deel's report notes high demand for software developers and growing salaries; EOR packages cost ~\$599 per employee per month plus contractor management fees ¹⁸ .
Wise / PayPal / Payoneer	Cross-border payment platforms	Widely used to receive USD payments; contractors should still issue invoices and register with DIAN ²² .

Income Target Realism

- Achieving **US\$1.5k/month** is feasible with mid-level remote contracting from LATAM rates (Unity developers in Colombia bill \$27–\$35/hr $\approx$ \$4.3k–6.0k/mo ¹⁶). After social security and taxes, net income may align with \$3k–4k/mo.
- Aiming for **US\$3k/month** (gross) is realistic if securing a mid-level Unity/WebGL contract or multiple Python automation contracts; LATAM mid remote Python salaries (\$44k/yr) correspond to \$3.7k/mo ¹³ .
- Reaching **US\$6k/month** requires tapping into higher-paying markets (US/EU digital-twin, AR/VR, simulation or senior Unity roles). Contractor rates of \$50–60/hr would produce \$8k–9.6k/mo but often require significant experience and may restrict remote to legal residents.

Notes on Confidence and Data Gaps

- Some roles (Technical Artist, Tools Developer, Unity WebGL) lack robust salary data outside the US; they are approximated using general Unity developer figures.
- European salary data comes mainly from Qubit Labs (2025) and may not reflect all industries; further research into country-specific salary databases would improve accuracy.
- Contractor rate data is available for Unity developers but scarce for technical artists and XR developers; general Unity rates are used as proxies.
- Legal and tax summaries are high-level; candidates should consult accountants or legal advisors for personalized compliance.

¹ Salary: Technical Artist (Jun, 2026) United States

<https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Salaries/Technical-Artist-Salary>

² ³ ⁴ ⁵ ⁶ ¹⁵ Unity Developer Salary Breakdown: What to Expect in 2025

<https://qubit-labs.com/average-unity-developer-salary-in-the-us-and-world/>

⁷ 2025 Latin America Software Developer Salaries: Verified Data from Howdy.com | Howdy

<https://www.howdy.com/blog/2025-latin-america-software-developer-salaries>

⁸ Technical Artist Job Trends, Salaries & Skill Sets | IT Jobs Watch

<https://www.itjobswatch.co.uk/jobs/uk/technical%20artist.do>

⁹ Salary: Simulation Software Engineer (Jun, 2026) US

<https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Salaries/Simulation-Software-Engineer-Salary>

- 10 11 **Salary: Digital Twin Engineer (Jun, 2026) United States**
<https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Salaries/Digital-Twin-Engineer-Salary>
- 12 **AR/VR Salary Insights – Typical XR Pay by Country & Seniority**
<https://www.arvrjobs.dev/ar-vr-salary-insights>
- 13 **Python Developer Salary in Latin America (2026) | HireTalent.lat**
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- 14 **3D Artist Salary: Hourly Rate June 2026 USA**
<https://www.ziprecruiter.com/Salaries/3D-Artist-Salary>
- 16 17 **Unity Developer Hourly Rate & Salary 2026: \$30–\$89/hr by Region**
<https://lemon.io/rate-calculator/unity-developers/>
- 18 **Global Hiring Report 2026 | Deel: AI & Remote Work Trends**
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